

Annexure A

Community Development Project

On

Cyber Security Awareness

(Be a Cyber Smart)

Submitted by

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Annexure B

Certification by the NGO regarding the Student Project



Annexure C

1. Introduction

In today's fast-changing digital world, cyber security is a major concern for both individuals and society. With more people using smartphones, online banking, e-commerce, and social media, they face various cyber threats like phishing, malware, identity theft, and online fraud. Unfortunately, many individuals do not know enough about safe online practices, making them easy targets for cybercriminals.

To tackle this problem, a Cyber Security Awareness Program was organized for 40 individuals from diverse backgrounds, including students, professionals, and homemakers. The initiative aimed to improve their understanding of cyber risks and teach them how to protect their personal and financial information online.

Through interactive sessions, demonstrations, and real-life case studies, participants learned about common cyber threats and how to prevent them. The program also promoted responsible technology use, safe digital payment practices, and effective social media management. By raising awareness at the grassroots level, this project helps build a safer and more resilient digital community where individuals can secure themselves and educate others at home and work.

2. Problem Identification and Cause of the Problem

The main issue identified was the lack of awareness about cyber security among individuals, which often leads to online fraud, data theft, and identity misuse. Many participants admitted to using weak passwords, ignoring software updates, or sharing sensitive information on unsafe platforms. This problem stems from inadequate digital literacy, excessive reliance on technology, and carelessness when using online services. Without basic cyber hygiene, individuals become easy targets for scams and digital exploitation.

3. Objective to be Achieved

The goal of this program was to create awareness and build digital safety skills among 40 individuals. The specific objectives included:

- Introducing participants to various cyber threats like phishing, malware, and financial fraud.
- Encouraging strong password practices, two-factor authentication, and data backups.
- Teaching individuals how to use social media safely and share personal information responsibly.
- Promoting secure digital financial practices, like safe online transactions and recognizing fraud messages or calls.
- Making participants aware of cyber laws and official reporting mechanisms available in India.

By achieving these objectives, the program aimed to empower participants to protect themselves in the digital world and spread cyber awareness in their communities.

4. Various Steps Taken to Achieve the Objectives

The program was implemented in a structured way, divided into four phases: planning, training, hands-on demonstrations, and evaluation.

Phase 1: Planning and Preparation

- Identification of 40 participants from different backgrounds.
- Conducting a pre-program survey to assess their existing cyber knowledge.
- Designing content in simple language with case studies and visuals.
- Preparing training materials, including PPTs, videos, and handouts.
- Inviting cyber security experts to lead sessions.

Phase 2: Training Sessions

Training was delivered in two batches to ensure better engagement. The sessions included:

1. Introduction to Cyber Threats – Real-world examples of phishing, ransomware, and online scams were presented.
2. Password Security – Demonstrations on how hackers crack weak passwords and how to create strong ones were conducted.
3. Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) – Hands-on demonstration of enabling 2FA on email and banking apps.
4. Safe Browsing Practices – Identifying secure websites (https), avoiding suspicious downloads, and clearing cache and cookies.
5. Email and Social Media Safety – Recognizing spam or fake messages, avoiding oversharing, and preventing account hacking.
6. Digital Payments and Banking Security – Using official apps, avoiding fake links, and enabling transaction alerts.
7. Mobile and Device Protection – Installing antivirus, updating software regularly, and avoiding unsafe Wi-Fi networks.
8. Cyber Laws and Reporting – Awareness about India's Cyber Crime Portal (cybercrime.gov.in) and how to file complaints.

Phase 3: Practical Demonstrations and Activities

1. Phishing Simulation: A fake phishing email was shown, and participants identified red flags like suspicious links.
2. Password Strength Test: Volunteers tested the strength of their passwords.
3. Group Discussion: Participants shared experiences of digital fraud and discussed preventive measures.
4. Case Studies: Analysis of actual incidents where negligence led to data loss or financial scams.
5. Awareness Pledge: All 40 participants pledged to follow cyber-safe practices.

Phase 4: Follow-up and Evaluation

1. A post-program test measured knowledge improvement, showing a significant rise in awareness.

2. Feedback forms were collected, with most participants rating the sessions as highly beneficial.
3. A WhatsApp awareness group was set up for ongoing sharing of tips, resources, and cyber alerts.
4. Participants were encouraged to spread awareness among their families, workplaces, and neighborhoods.

This structured and participatory approach made the program informative, practical, and impactful.

5. Geo-Tagged Pictures



6. Effectiveness of the Project

The Cyber Security Awareness Program was very effective in achieving its goals. Post-program surveys showed that over 70% of participants improved their knowledge of cyber security practices. Many immediately implemented two-factor authentication, updated their passwords, and began using antivirus software. Several participants provided positive feedback, stating that they felt more confident using online banking and social media responsibly.

Testimonials indicated that the program not only educated them but also inspired them to act as advocates of digital safety within their families and workplaces. The follow-up WhatsApp group offered ongoing learning, keeping participants informed about emerging threats. The mix of interactive teaching, real-life examples, and hands-on demonstrations made the program engaging and memorable.

7. Identified Societal Problems

During the project, two major societal problems were identified:

1. Digital Illiteracy – Many people, especially in rural and semi-urban areas, lack basic digital skills. They struggle to identify online scams or fraudulent messages, making them very vulnerable to cyber threats.
2. Financial Fraud and Online Scams – Rising cases of UPI frauds, phishing calls, and fake shopping websites highlight the lack of awareness about secure financial practices among ordinary citizens.

Addressing these problems requires ongoing awareness campaigns, integration of cyber safety in school curriculums, and stronger community involvement.

8. Conclusion

The Cyber Security Awareness Program for 40 individuals successfully reached its objectives by providing knowledge, skills, and confidence to help them navigate the digital world safely. In an era where technology influences every part of life, cyber security is essential.

Through structured training, interactive sessions, and hands-on demonstrations, participants learned to protect their personal information, secure financial transactions, and use social media responsibly. The program's impact went beyond the 40 individuals, as many pledged to share that knowledge in their communities, creating a ripple effect.

Importantly, this project also highlighted broader societal issues like digital illiteracy and increasing cyber fraud. These challenges call for long-term solutions, such as integrating cyber safety education in schools, conducting public awareness campaigns, and strengthening law enforcement mechanisms.

Overall, this project showed that awareness is the first line of defense against cyber threats. By creating informed digital citizens, we contribute to a safer, more resilient society where individuals can fully benefit from technology without falling victims to its risks.